06

INCREASE YOUR INCOME

Cutting has a ceiling. Earning has none. The math, the moves, and how to stop perfecting the LLC and find your first paying customer this week.

CK ACADEMY

A COLLECTIVE KINDNESS INITIATIVE

01 READ THIS FIRST

You picked the structure. Now close the gap.

If you did Class 02, you know your structure (paycheck, asset, or profession). This class is about the next layer: the income gap inside that structure, and the single specific move that closes it.

Most frum couples spend 90% of their financial energy on the floor: budget, cuts, deal-finding. Then they wonder why they're still tight. The floor has hard limits. Tuition, kosher food, and housing don't compress past a point.

Earning more has no ceiling. By Sunday you'll have made the ONE income move that maps to your structure: salary conversation if paycheck, paid skill if profession, first paying customer if asset.

WHAT THIS CLASS IS NOT

Not a sales pitch for entrepreneurship. Not generic "build multiple income streams" advice. Not a passive income fantasy. This is the page that ends with you having a market-rate number, an enrolled course, or a paying customer's name.

02 THE MIRROR

Three numbers about your income.

WRITE THE NUMBERS FROM YOUR OWN LIFE

Pull up your last W-2 or year-end summary. We need real numbers. If row 2 makes you uncomfortable, that's the data this class fixes.

1. Your total compensation last year (salary + bonus + benefits)	$ _____
2. Market rate for your role at your level (talk to 3 peers, or check levels.fyi / Glassdoor)	$ _____
3. Gap between rows 1 and 2	$ _____
4. Skill someone outside your company would pay you for tomorrow	_____
5. Side income, last 12 months	$ _____

Row 3 over $10K is a negotiation problem you can fix in one conversation. Row 4 blank is a skill-building problem you can start this week. Row 5 at zero means the network around you isn't being used. Pick the move below that fits your gap.

03 THREE MOVES, IN ORDER

Negotiate. Build. Sell.

These are listed in order of speed-to-money. Most people skip move 1 entirely (it feels uncomfortable), romanticize move 3 (it feels exciting), and never do move 2 (it feels boring). Reverse that.

Move 1 / Get paid more for what you already do

Talk to 3-5 peers in your role at other companies. Confirm market rate. Have ONE conversation with your boss backed by data: "I love what we're building. Market rate for this role is $X. I want to be paid in line with my contribution. Can we make that happen?" Don't threaten. Ask. If no, start interviewing. **Average frum couples leave $10-30K/year on the table because this conversation never happens.**

Move 2 / Build a skill someone will pay for

Sales. AI/data. Tech. Finance. Skilled trades (HVAC, electrical, plumbing). The market pays a premium for skills that are scarce and solve expensive problems. One hour a day, 90 days, you're not an expert but you're past zero. One year, you're employable in the new field. Pick something the market clearly pays for, not something "interesting."

Move 3 / Find one paying customer

The mistake every aspiring frum entrepreneur makes: builds the LLC, the logo, and the website BEFORE finding one paying customer. Reverse it. Find one customer first. The dollar tells you the business is real. Until then, it's all decoration.

04 THE RULE THAT PREVENTS WASTED YEARS

The rule.

CUSTOMER BEFORE LLC

If you're building anything to earn income on the side, find one paying customer before you file the LLC, design the logo, build the website, or print business cards. The first dollar is the only proof the business is real.

What "finding one customer" actually looks like

If you can do bookkeeping: post in your community group offering to handle one small business's books for $300/month. Talk to 3 prospects this week. Get one yes.

If you can build websites: post that you'll build a 5-page site for $750 for the first 2 frum businesses. Two yeses by end of month.

If you can tutor: post one subject, $40/hour. Three students by end of week.

If you have a trade skill (handy, plumbing, painting): post that you'll do small home jobs on Sunday afternoons. Three jobs in 30 days.

> THE INFRASTRUCTURE TRAP
>
> If you've spent more than 4 hours on logos, websites, business cards, or LLC paperwork without having a paying customer yet, **stop. Find the customer.** Everything else can come after.

05 WHERE THIS FAILS

Boring beats exciting.

Most frum guys who try to increase income end up with nothing to show for it after 12 months. Here's why, in the exact order it fails.

TRAP 1 / THE LIFESTYLE HUSTLE

Trying to be an Instagram brand, a YouTube creator, a TikTok personality, with no specific paid skill. **Near-zero success rate.** The path is glamorous but customers don't exist. Skill-based hustle (bookkeeping for 3 small businesses, web dev for one local company, tutoring) is boring but customers exist immediately.

TRAP 2 / PERFECTING THE INFRASTRUCTURE

Three months in, you have a beautiful logo, an LLC, a Stripe account, a website, business cards, and zero customers. **You confused looking like a business with being one.** The infrastructure is decoration on top of nothing. Find the customer first. Everything else is a tax-deductible afterthought.

TRAP 3 / NEVER ASKING FOR THE RAISE

You'll spend a year being underpaid because the negotiation feels uncomfortable. **The discomfort is finite (one 20-minute conversation). The lost income is forever (compounds for 30 years).** Pick discomfort once.

TRAP 4 / HIDING THE WORK FROM YOUR SPOUSE

You'll start something on the side and not tell your spouse until "it's working." **It rarely starts working without their support.** Looping them in early creates accountability and reduces resentment when you spend 6 hours on a Sunday on it.

06 THE ACTION

BY SUNDAY, 9 PM

Do this. Now.

ONE deliverable based on your structure (from Class 02). Not all three moves. ONE.

01 **If your structure is Paycheck:** Talk to 3 peers in your role at OTHER companies this week and confirm market rate. Schedule the comp conversation with your boss for next week. Write the script.

The deliverable: 3 peer salary data points + meeting on calendar. Not the conversation itself, just the meeting scheduled.

02 **If your structure is Profession:** Enroll in the next credential or skill course this week. Block the calendar hours for the next 90 days.

Specific course, specific hours, specific 90-day end date. "I'll figure out the course" doesn't count.

03 **If your structure is Asset:** Post in your community group offering ONE service for a clear price. Talk to 3 prospects this week. Get one paying yes by Sunday.

If you can't get one paying yes from your community network, the offer or pricing isn't right yet. That itself is the data.

04 **Text your spouse the structure-specific deliverable.** Words: "Class 06 done. Move: [specific]. Result: [outcome]."

If you can't articulate the move and the outcome in one sentence, you haven't done one.

PROOF OF COMPLETION

Either: 3 peer salary data points + scheduled boss meeting (Paycheck), enrolled course + 90-day calendar block (Profession), or posted offer + first paying customer named (Asset). Text to spouse with which move and what result.

07 THE CONVERSATION

Tonight. With your spouse.

RULES

30 minutes. Phone away. The income conversation often turns into a status conversation. Stay on numbers and moves, not on whose career is more important. Both spouses' incomes are family income.

01 What's our combined household income now, and what does it need to be at 35? At 40? Run the math.

Specific numbers, not 'more.'

02 Of the three moves, which one fits each of us best? It's okay if we pick different ones.

Both spouses can do this. It doesn't have to be one earner's project.

03 What skill have we been talking about building for over a year and never started? Why?

The honest answer to 'why' is usually: nobody made us start.

04 Is there someone in our community we've been afraid to ask for help, advice, or work? Name them.

Frum networks are dense. The ask costs nothing.

05 What does success look like 12 months from now? Specific dollar amount or specific milestone.

Pick the metric we'll measure against.

SECTION TWO

Test.

10 questions. None of these can be answered from memory of the lesson. You'll need real numbers from your own life.

08 THE TEST

Test.

Each question requires real numbers, real names, or real decisions from your life. Do the work. Skipping defeats the point.

1. NUMBERS **Run the gap math: at 40, we want $X household income. Currently we make $Y. Trajectory of current jobs takes us to $Z. Gap at 40 = $X - $Z. Show all four numbers.**

2. ACTION **Talk to 3 peers in your role at other companies this week. Write each of their first names, what they earn, and the source you used. If you can't do this in 7 days, the discomfort is the problem.**

3. ACTION **Write the exact 4-sentence message you'll send your boss to schedule the comp conversation. Must be sendable as written. Include the specific request.**

4. DECISION **Pick one specific skill from: Sales, AI/Data, Tech, Finance, Trade. Why this one for you specifically? Where will you learn it (specific course or channel)? What hours per week?**

5. ACTION **Write the exact community post you'd use to find your first paying customer. What service, what price, what guarantee. Must be postable as written.**

08 THE TEST, CONTINUED

6. TRAP TEST — It's month 3 of side hustling. You have a logo, an LLC, a website, and zero customers. What's your next move? Specific decision and why.

7. REAL LIFE — Find one frum person in your community who increased income through one of the three moves. Real story. What did they do, when, and what was the result? First name, real numbers.

8. NUMBERS — If you're $15K below market and negotiate to close the gap, calculate: that's $X/month. Invested at 9% over 25 years (until retirement), that's $Y. Show the compound impact of one conversation.

9. TRAP TEST — Your spouse says "why are you doing this side work? We're fine." What do you say? Show you've thought about WHY this matters, not just THAT it matters.

10. DECISION — By Sunday, what is your ONE deliverable? Specific. Time-bound. Verifiable. Write the sentence: "By [date], I will have [specific action]."

09 WHAT A STRONG ANSWER LOOKS LIKE

Reference.

These aren't right answers. They're examples of strong answers, written with real specificity. If yours are vaguer than these, redo them.

1. Strong: "At 40 we want $300K HHI. Currently $145K. Trajectory takes us to $190K by 40. Gap at 40 = $110K. To close it, I need to add $50K via Move 1 (negotiate to market) plus $60K via Move 3 (asset/side income)." Weak: any vague answer.

2. Strong: "Yossi at [other firm], $135K. R.S. at [different firm], $148K. Y.F., $128K plus bonus. Source: direct DMs and one coffee. Took 4 days." Weak: "I'll get to it." If the discomfort stops you from asking three peers, this whole class will fail.

3. Strong: "Hi [Boss], I'd like to schedule 30 minutes to talk through my comp. I've been doing X and Y, market rate for this role is around $Z, and I want to discuss aligning my package. Could we find time next week?" Sayable.

4. Strong: "Sales, specifically B2B sales for SaaS. Why: high ceiling, hireable in frum-heavy NYC market, no degree required. Where: Hubspot Academy + the LinkedIn course by [name]. 5 hours/week, Tuesday/Thursday evenings." Weak: "I'll learn something useful."

5. Strong: "Looking to take on 2 small businesses for monthly bookkeeping. $300/month, includes monthly P&L and bank reconciliation. First month free if you switch from your current bookkeeper. DM me." Postable as written.

6. Strong: "Stop. Find a customer this week. The website, LLC, and logo will be slightly different once I have a real customer's needs. Rebuild later. Today: post in 3 community groups offering my service at a discount for the first paying customer."

7. Real names, real moves, real numbers. "Y.K. moved from $90K paycheck role to senior IC at a tech company at $185K through Move 1 (negotiation). Took him 4 months and 6 interviews. The key: stopped accepting 5% raises."

8. Strong: "$15K/year = $1,250/month. Invested at 9% over 25 years = $1,402,000. One uncomfortable 20-minute conversation worth $1.4M of family wealth."

9. Strong: "We're not 'fine' if I'm leaving $25K/year on the table or if our family ceiling caps where my role caps. The side work is optional now and protective in 5 years if my industry shifts. Doing it now while we're young is cheap insurance." Weak: "It's just something I want to do."

10. Strong: "By Sunday 11/24, I will have spoken to 3 peers about market rate, written the message to my boss, and scheduled the conversation for the following week." Specific. Time-bound. Verifiable.